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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

'A tale of two Mike Madigans' on stand

Testimony offered life story, but also route to sentence

By Ray Long and Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Months before a federal judge sentenced former Illinois House Speaker Michael Madigan to prison on Friday, the once-mighty state Democratic Party chairman took the witness stand in his corruption trial in an attempt to save himself.

The only politician in America to serve 36 years as a House speaker guided jurors through his version of a complex personal and political life where few have gone before.

For a high-profile Chicago politician that some called the "sphinx" because of his secrecy, Madigan's decision to testify demonstrated he could not sit by and let his fate play out without speaking up.

On Friday, Madigan found himself in a different posture, pleading for mercy as he asked for more time with a family that included an ailing wife.

"When I look back on my life, being speaker is not what gives me the most pride," Madigan said. "I am most proud of being a good husband, a good father and now a good grandfather."

In sentencing Madigan to seven and a half years in federal prison and fining him \$2.5 million, U.S. District Judge John Robert Blakey made it clear that Madigan's decision to testify at trial had cost him dearly. The judge called some aspects of his testimony about the details of the alleged schemes "a nauseating display of perjury" that was "hard to watch."

Blakey said he was struck by what essentially was "a tale of two different Mike Madigans," a play on the theme of a Charles Dickens classic, adding that the

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Massive crowds gather in downtown Chicago for 'No Kings' demonstration in admonishment of Trump, mixing anti-authoritarian messaging with vows to protect immigrants, democracy

'WE'RE ALL PEOPLE'



Demonstrators begin to march at Daley Plaza in Chicago on Saturday. JOHN J. KIM/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

By Andrew Carter, Shanzeh Ahmad and Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

The sounds of one of Chicago's largest protests in recent memory reverberated throughout downtown streets Saturday afternoon, as tens of thousands gathered in a united admonishment of President Donald Trump and then marched through the center of the city, pausing in front of the tower bearing his name to direct their ire.

Organizers believed the downtown Chicago protest to be one of the largest among the more than 1,500 "No Kings" protests that were scheduled throughout the country, in what leaders of the demonstrations described as "a national mobilization to reject authoritarianism and stand united against fear."

Theresa and Robert Hoban, retired attorneys who split their time between Chicago and Florida, were among those who crowded into downtown Saturday morning and waited for the protest to begin. They were "doing this for our grandchildren's future," Theresa Hoban said, "because we believe the country has taken a turn for the worse under this administration."

In an intentional move, the "No Kings" protests were planned for the same day as President Donald Trump's 79th birthday and the military parade his administration organized in Washington, D.C., at a cost estimated to be as much as \$45 million. "No Kings" organizers said in a statement Saturday afternoon that millions gathered around the country, and that "the turnout has exceeded expectations."

In Chicago, those attending

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■ From red states to deep blue cities, a look at Saturday's "No Kings" protests across the nation. **Nation & World**

Martinez reflects as tumultuous CPS reign ends

By Nell Salzman
Chicago Tribune

At an eighth grade graduation last week at his alma mater, John A. Walsh Elementary School in Pilsen, outgoing schools chief Pedro Martinez recounted to parents and students how one teacher — Mr. Asher — turned the trajectory of his life around.

"I was below grade level. I was struggling, frankly. You know, I grew up in poverty," Martinez said. "And (he) just saw something in me."

Martinez is leaving the district

on Wednesday. In an interview with the Tribune on Thursday, he emotionally recounted his passion for Chicago Public Schools and for the city where he found a home as the child of Mexican immigrants. He urged the next leader of the district to practice empathy in order to set an example for the more than 320,000 kids they will oversee.

The top district official drew national attention this school year amid a showdown between



Martinez

CPS and Mayor Brandon Johnson, who was backed by the mayor's close ally, the Chicago Teachers Union. That conflict culminated Wednesday in a claim of defamation Martinez filed against CTU, its president, Stacy Davis Gates, and Chicago Board of Education President Sean Harden. Martinez hopes to add the claim as an amendment to an ongoing lawsuit he filed against the board after he was fired in late December.

He starts a new job as the commissioner of elementary and secondary education in Massachusetts on July 1. In the interview with the Tribune, Martinez did not hold back from describing the toll the drama-laden back-and-forth had taken on him and his family. He compared the political positions of the board members and officials who led the charge to fire him to the polarization under President Donald Trump.

"What you see on both sides is

Turn to Martinez, Page 4

NATION & WORLD Parade projects military might

The grand military parade that President Donald Trump had been wanting for eight years kicked off Saturday evening with tanks, troops and a 21-gun salute, playing out against the counterpoint of protesters around the country.

ONE CENTURY, ONE ROAD: Tribune's Route 66 series continues with a closer look at Arizona's roadside charms. **Chicagoland, Page 6**

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 80 Low 62

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 20

\$5.75 city and suburbs and elsewhere
178th year No. 166 © Chicago Tribune



CHICAGO'S 20 BEST 25 RESTAURANTS

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Wednesday, July 16
6–9 p.m.
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Marina's Bistro

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